



CONTACT COLLECTION MANAGEMENT

Document ID: SH-J2-COLLECT-001 | **Version:** 1.1.0 | **Effective:** September 3, 2026 | **State:** LOCKED

Owner: Contact | **Related:** Judgment, Judgment Watch, JAG, Orientation priorities | **Cross-reference:** CONTACT.md; JUDGMENT_OFFICER_PROFESSION.md; J2_HEADQUARTERS.md

Purpose

Contact exists to reduce the distance between reality and Sable Harbor's awareness of reality. It preserves direct institutional contact with machine data, documents, people, external sources, and physical operations so that management reporting layers, incentives, summaries, and internal narratives do not become substitutes for reality.

Contact is a mixed human and technical collection profession. It is not an analysis pool and not an org-chart mirror. Collectors go to sources, systems, people, sites, artifacts, and externally observable reality. They return sourced observations, provenance, limitations, and unresolved gaps. Judgment and Orientation determine meaning elsewhere.

Requirements contract

Contact is not self-directing. Orientation establishes broad enterprise questions and priority intelligence requirements. A Judgment Officer translates a problem commission into specific collection requirements and RFIs. J2 HQ arbitrates conflicts and scarce capacity. Contact determines lawful source, collection method, timing, provenance, and handoff.

A requirement states the question, discriminating evidence sought, why it matters, responsible problem owner, timing, known gaps, restrictions, and completion/disposition. The requirement must not imply the desired answer. Contact may challenge an infeasible or poorly discriminating requirement and return it for refinement; this is professional collection judgment, not ownership of the underlying belief.

Collector bench and cell model

Contact maintains a standing professional bench rather than permanent problem silos. When a live collection requirement requires concentrated work, a Collection Director is designated cell lead and drafts the needed disciplines from the bench. Cells are temporary, problem-centered teams. They form around a requirement, operate for as long as the requirement demands, hand off evidence, and dissolve.

Collectors retain their professional discipline while working operationally for the cell lead during the assignment. A cell may therefore combine human collection, systems/data work, field-technical observation, and external-source collection in one team rather than routing a problem through separate bureaucratic departments.

Bench time is intentional professional time, not idle capacity. Collectors use it for advanced training, source and relationship development, domain study, access-path validation, methods work, field familiarization, controlled rotations, and standing low-intensity coverage. The model is deliberately analogous to a high-end consulting bench: Sable Harbor carries excess professional depth so that the right team can be assembled rapidly without hollowing out standing capability.

Establishment

The working Contact establishment is approximately **78 billets**:

- Head of Contact — 1
- Deputy Head of Contact — 1
- Collection Directors — 6
- Collection Managers — 8
- Human Contact Officers — 20
- Digital/Data Collectors — 16
- Field and Technical Collectors — 14
- External-Source Collectors — 10
- Collection Methods Officers — 2

Collection Directors are senior problem owners for active collection cells rather than chiefs of permanent empires. Collection Managers maintain requirements, deconfliction, tasking state, outstanding gaps, and handoff discipline. Senior individual-contributor careers remain available so excellence does not require people management.

The operating model assumes several concurrent cells of different sizes and preserves a meaningful bench rather than seeking full utilization. Roughly sixty to seventy percent deployed utilization is a planning norm, not a productivity target. J2 does not reward Contact for keeping everyone continuously billable.

Collection disciplines and methods

Systems and digital collection retrieves from databases, logs, operational platforms, finance systems, Foundry, Alexandria interfaces, and other authorized internal systems through queries, extracts, standing pulls, time-bounded captures, and preservation. Retrieval does not become institutional judgment.

Human collection uses structured elicitation, interviews, relationship networks, direct contact, and directed asks. Collectors may tell employees what observations matter during a defined period, which facts to capture, and how to report them. Employees can become distributed sensors without becoming covert surveillance subjects.

Field and technical collection directly observes physical work, assets, engineering conditions, operating environments, equipment, facilities, and processes. It can walk a plant floor, inspect an operating condition, accompany field work, verify what a system or asset actually does, and reconcile physical reality against system representations.

JAG collection tasks field teams for observation, artifacts, interviews, operating context, and ground truth. JAG reports what it saw and the limits of observation; it does not issue institutional conclusions.

External collection is requirement-driven lawful research across public, regulatory, commercial, market, expert, supplier, customer, competitor, community, and other authorized sources. Contact does not substitute generic news aggregation for a collection plan.

Exploitation recognizes an information-rich event—lost bid, incident, unusual maintenance, successful intervention, capital decision, outage, customer failure—as a fleeting collection opportunity. Contact acts while evidence, memory, and artifacts remain fresh and respects legal, safety, privilege, and preservation constraints.

Directed observation and evidence creation applies when discriminating evidence does not exist. Contact can help design a controlled test, new measurement, structured observation, targeted data capture, or structured

interview program. The record distinguishes observed evidence from designed conditions and preserves method and limitations.

Collection board

The active register shows requirements, assigned method/source, cell or collector, clock, current status, outstanding gaps, restrictions, provenance state, and evidentiary handoff. Flash/Current/Active/Standing tempo language remains PROVISIONAL and may not be presented as final policy.

Metrics emphasize important gaps closed, relevance, timeliness, provenance quality, and discriminating value. Report count, event volume, utilization, and data accumulation are not success measures. Universal surveillance, fishing expeditions, and raw-event hoarding violate doctrine.

Handoff

Evidence is handed to the owning JO with source identity or protected-source handling, event/record/access time, method, chain of custody where applicable, known limitations, and unanswered gaps. Contact preserves the raw signal; it does not smooth ambiguity into a convenient summary.

Controlled publication • Generated from docs/j2/CONTACT_COLLECTION_MANAGEMENT.md • Do not alter PDF manually